consulting Rakesh Mohan, deputy governor, who was also in Washington for the meetings, and Alpana Killawala, the Reserve Bank's competent and affable communications chief, I decided that the balance of advantage lay in meeting the media in Washington. Not only would it be sooner but we would also be reaching out to the international media.

One young rookie journalist who had travelled from India was calling my staff several times a day for an exclusive interview with me. My staff told her that I neither had the time nor the inclination for one-on-one interactions. As time went by, she became increasingly desperate. At some point, she called me directly, and on the verge of tears told me that her editor had sent her all the way to Washington on the condition that she would interview the new governor, and if she failed, it would dent her career prospects. Even as I sympathized with her, I could not oblige. Given all the pressures on my time, I found it difficult to accommodate her career prospects in my priorities. When I scheduled the media conference, I told my staff to make sure to invite her too.

At the media conference which lasted maybe about ten minutes, there were questions seeking explanation for the actions the Reserve Bank had taken, and I valued the opportunity of elaborating our stance. There were questions about why India was affected by the unfolding crisis; I had a reasonable explanation for it. The questions I found most difficult to address were those concerning the future—how would the situation evolve and what actions would we take? These were in the realm of speculation, there was too much uncertainty around the world and the gloomy G20 meeting the previous evening was very fresh in my mind. I found it hard to be definitive or forthright.

As an aside, I must add that the rookie journalist has since grown into a well-regarded and knowledgeable professional in her media house. Whenever she ran into me in the five years that I was in the Reserve Bank, she would thank me for her success, always leaving me feeling guilty about this undeserved gratitude.

Frankly, I was getting increasingly uncomfortable by the hour and was eager to be back in my office. I cut short my stay by a day and took the